

Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors

PEER RECOVERY ASSOCIATE — Application Manual

IC&RC Credential Code: PR-A

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About the Peer Recovery Associate Credential

The Peer Recovery Associate (PR-A) credential is offered by the Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors (ABCAC) in partnership with the International Certification & Reciprocity Consortium (IC&RC). This credential is designed for individuals who have personal lived experience with mental health and/or substance use conditions and who wish to provide peer support services in the state of Arizona.

Peer Recovery Associates serve as a critical bridge between people in recovery and the behavioral health system. They offer hope, guidance, and connection to resources through the unique power of shared lived experience.

IC&RC Reciprocity: The PR-A credential is recognized across all IC&RC member boards, enabling reciprocal certification for qualified applicants who relocate or practice across state lines.

Certifying Board: Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors (ABCAC)

Credential Name: Peer Recovery Associate

IC&RC Code: PR-A

Application Fee: \$150.00 (non-refundable)

Renewal: Every two (2) years | 20 continuing education hours | \$150.00 renewal fee

Contact: abcacb@abcac.org | (480) 980-1770 | www.abcac.org

Application Criteria

To qualify for the Peer Recovery Associate credential, applicants must meet ALL of the following requirements. Documentation for each requirement must be submitted with the completed application.

1. Lived Experience

The applicant must have personal lived experience with a mental health and/or substance use condition and must demonstrate how that experience informs their peer support work. Lived experience must be described and attested on Form B (Lived Experience Attestation), included in this application packet.

2. Training

The applicant must complete a minimum of 40 hours of training through an AHCCCS-recognized Peer Support Employment Training Program. Training must cover the four IC&RC PR-A practice domains: (1) Advocacy, (2) Education & Support, (3) Community Resources, and (4) Professional Responsibility. A minimum of 6 hours must specifically address ethics. Applicants must submit a certificate of completion or a signed letter from the training provider documenting the number of hours completed.

3. Examination

The applicant must pass the board-approved examination administered through their AHCCCS-recognized Peer Support Employment Training Program. The examination is not administered through a third-party testing center. Applicants must submit proof of passing (certificate or letter from the training provider) with the application.

4. Supervision Agreement

The applicant must submit a completed Supervision Agreement (Form C) identifying a qualified supervisor who will oversee their peer support practice. The agreement must be signed by both the applicant and the supervisor prior to or at the time of application. Supervised practice hours shall not exceed 120 hours for purposes of the PR-A application.

5. Code of Ethics

The applicant must sign the ABCAC Code of Ethics Affirmation (Form A), affirming that they have read, understand, and will abide by the NAADAC Ethical Standards (Principles 1–12) and the peer-specific ethical principles adopted by ABCAC. The signed Form A must be submitted with the application.

6. Application Fee

A non-refundable application fee of \$150.00 must be submitted with the completed application. Checks or money orders should be made payable to: Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors. ABCAC does not accept cash.

7. Arizona Residency / Jurisdiction

Applicants must demonstrate that the primary location of their peer support practice is within the state of Arizona. A minimum of 51% of the applicant's peer support professional activities must occur within Arizona. The applicant must attest to Arizona residency and practice jurisdiction on the Application for Certification.

Certification Application Checklist

Complete all items below before submitting your application to ABCAC. Incomplete applications will not be processed.

Completed Application for Certification (this packet — all pages, fully completed and signed)

Form A — Code of Ethics Affirmation (signed by applicant)

Form B — Lived Experience Attestation (signed by applicant)

Form C — Supervision Agreement (signed by both applicant and supervisor)

Training Documentation — training certificate or letter confirming 40 hours from an AHCCCS-recognized Peer Support Employment Training Program

Examination Documentation — examination certificate or letter confirming passing score from the training provider

Application Fee — non-refundable application fee of \$150.00 (check or money order payable to ABCAC)

Submit completed application to:

Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors (ABCAC), PO Box 83165, Phoenix, AZ 85071.

Applications may also be submitted by email to abcacb@abcac.org. Please contact ABCAC at (480) 980-1770 to confirm current submission procedures.

APPLICATION FOR CERTIFICATION

Peer Recovery Associate (PR-A)

Section A — Applicant Information

Last Name: _____ First Name: _____ Middle Initial: _____
Preferred Name (if different): _____ Date of Birth (MM/DD/YYYY): _____
Current Street Address: _____
City: _____ State: _____ ZIP Code: _____
Home Phone: _____ Cell Phone: _____
Email Address: _____
Driver's License Number: _____ State of Issuance: _____

Section B — Training & Examination

Name of AHCCCS-Recognized Peer Support Employment Training Program: _____
Training Provider / Organization: _____
Training Start Date: _____ Training End Date: _____ Total Hours Completed: _____
Examination Date: _____ Examination Result (Pass/Fail): _____
Name of Person / Organization Administering Examination: _____

Section C — Current Employment / Practice Setting

Current Employer / Agency: _____
Employer Address: _____
Job Title: _____ Start Date: _____
Supervisor Name: _____ Supervisor Phone: _____
Supervisor Email: _____
Hours Per Week in Peer Support Role: _____ % of Practice in Arizona: _____

Section D — Background Information

Answer all questions truthfully. Answer YES or NO by checking the appropriate box. If you answer YES to any question, provide a full written explanation on a separate sheet of paper and attach it to this application.

1. Do you currently hold any other professional certifications or credentials in behavioral health, addiction counseling, or peer support? YES ☐ NO ☐
2. Have you ever held a behavioral health certification, license, or credential in Arizona or any other state? YES ☐ NO ☐
3. Has a certification, license, or credential application ever been denied, withdrawn, or rejected by any board or organization? YES ☐ NO ☐
4. Has any disciplinary action ever been taken against a certification, license, or credential you hold or held? YES ☐ NO ☐
5. Have you ever voluntarily surrendered a certification, license, or credential while under investigation or to avoid disciplinary action? YES ☐ NO ☐
6. Are you currently under investigation by any professional regulatory body, certifying organization, or licensing board? YES ☐ NO ☐
7. Have you ever been convicted of a crime (felony or misdemeanor), pled guilty or no contest, or had a conviction expunged or set aside? YES ☐ NO ☐
8. Has a civil judgment or malpractice claim ever been entered against you in connection with your professional services? YES ☐ NO ☐
9. Have you ever been involuntarily terminated from employment for reasons related to professional conduct, substance use, or client safety? YES ☐ NO ☐

Section E — Arizona Residency & Jurisdiction Certification

I certify that I am a resident of the state of Arizona and that the primary location of my peer support practice is within Arizona. I further certify that at least 51% of my professional peer support activities occur within the state of Arizona.

Applicant Signature: _____ Date: _____

Section F — Release and Authorization

I authorize the Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors (ABCAC) to investigate all information provided in this application. I authorize all persons and organizations, including employers, educational institutions, training providers, licensing and certifying bodies, and law enforcement agencies to release any information requested by ABCAC in connection with this application. I agree to waive any privilege or claim relating to such information for purposes of this application process. I understand that the submission of false, fraudulent, or misleading information is grounds for denial, suspension, or revocation of certification and may subject me to other legal consequences. I attest that all information provided in this application is true, accurate, and complete to the best of my knowledge.

Applicant Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name: _____

Current Credential(s) / Title (if any): _____

FORM A — CODE OF ETHICS AFFIRMATION

Peer Recovery Associate — Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors

As a condition of certification and as a continuing obligation of the Peer Recovery Associate (PR-A) credential, I affirm the following:

1. I will abide by the NAADAC Code of Ethics, including all twelve (12) ethical principles, as adopted by the Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors.
2. I will place the wellbeing, dignity, and recovery of every person I serve above all other considerations in my peer support practice.
3. I will not misrepresent my qualifications, credentials, role, or the scope of peer support services to any person, employer, or agency.
4. I will maintain appropriate boundaries and will not exploit the relationship, vulnerability, or trust of any person I serve.
5. I will hold all information shared with me in the peer support relationship in strict confidence, disclosing only as required by law or with the informed consent of the individual served.
6. I will practice within the scope of the Peer Recovery Associate credential and will refer individuals to licensed or clinical professionals when their needs exceed my role.
7. I will not allow personal recovery, bias, or self-interest to impair my professional judgment or my ability to serve others effectively.
8. I will continue to invest in my own recovery and in the professional development required to serve others with competence and integrity.
9. I will treat all individuals with respect, dignity, and cultural humility, honoring the diversity of recovery paths and lived experience.
10. I will report any violations of ethical standards by peers, colleagues, or supervisors to the appropriate authority as required.
11. I will cooperate fully with any investigation conducted by ABCAC related to my conduct or the conduct of others under this credential.
12. I understand that violation of this Code of Ethics may result in suspension or revocation of my Peer Recovery Associate certification.

By signing below, I affirm that I have read, understand, and agree to be bound by the ABCAC Code of Ethics and the NAADAC Ethical Standards as adopted by ABCAC. I commit to upholding these standards throughout the duration of my Peer Recovery Associate certification.

Applicant Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name: _____

Employer / Agency: _____

AHCCCS-Recognized Training Program Completed: _____

FORM B — LIVED EXPERIENCE ATTESTATION

Peer Recovery Associate — Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors

The Peer Recovery Associate credential is grounded in the power of shared lived experience. Applicants must describe their personal experience with a mental health and/or substance use condition and explain how that experience informs their desire and ability to provide peer support services to others.

Your response will be reviewed by ABCAC only and will be held in strict confidence. You are not required to disclose specific diagnoses, substances, or treatment history — only to confirm lived experience and describe how it shapes your peer support practice.

Applicant Name (Printed): _____

Date: _____

Part 1 — Lived Experience

Describe your personal experience with a mental health and/or substance use condition and the challenges you have faced and overcome. You do not need to disclose specific diagnoses or substances.

Part 2 — Connection to Peer Support Work

Explain how your lived experience informs your ability to support others in their recovery journey. Describe the strategies, insights, and strengths you have developed that will make you an effective Peer Recovery Associate.

I attest that the information provided above is truthful and accurately describes my lived experience. I understand that misrepresentation of lived experience is grounds for denial or revocation of the Peer Recovery Associate certification.

Applicant Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name: _____

FORM C — SUPERVISION AGREEMENT

Peer Recovery Associate — Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors

All applicants for the Peer Recovery Associate credential must have a qualified supervisor identified and agree to the terms of supervision as described below. This agreement must be signed by both the applicant and the supervisor and submitted with the application.

Section 1 — Applicant Information

Applicant Name: _____ Date: _____

Employer / Agency: _____

Job Title / Role: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Section 2 — Supervisor Information

Supervisor Name: _____ Credential(s): _____

Title / Position: _____

Agency / Organization: _____

Address: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Section 3 — Supervision Plan

Supervision Start Date: _____ Anticipated Hours of Supervision: _____

Method of Supervision (individual, group, combination): _____

Frequency of Supervision Sessions: _____

Section 4 — Agreement Terms

By signing below, both parties agree to the following terms:

1. The supervisor agrees to provide oversight, guidance, and support to the applicant in their peer support practice in accordance with the standards of the Peer Recovery Associate credential.
2. The supervisor agrees to be available for scheduled supervision sessions and to document supervision hours as required by ABCAC.
3. The applicant agrees to participate actively in supervision, to seek guidance when needed, and to practice within the scope of the PR-A credential.
4. Both parties understand that supervised practice hours submitted for PR-A certification shall not exceed 120 hours.
5. Either party may terminate this agreement with written notice. The applicant must notify ABCAC immediately if this supervision agreement is terminated.
6. Both parties attest that the information provided on this form is accurate and complete.

Applicant

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name: _____

Supervisor

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name: _____

Credential / License Number: _____

FORM D — TRAINING DOCUMENTATION

Peer Recovery Associate — Arizona Board for Certification of Addiction Counselors

Use this form to document the training hours completed through your AHCCCS-recognized Peer Support Employment Training Program. All 40 hours must be documented. Attach a certificate of completion or a signed letter from the training provider confirming total hours completed.

Applicant Name (Printed): _____

Training Program / Organization: _____

Training Program Instructor / Director: _____

Training Start Date: _____ Training End Date: _____

Training Log

List each training module or session completed. Attach additional pages if needed. Columns: Title of Course / Module — Date Completed — Hours — IC&RC Domain — Training Provider / Instructor.

IC&RC PR-A Domains: (1) Advocacy (2) Education & Support (3) Community Resources (4) Professional Responsibility

Total Hours Completed (must be 40 or more): _____

Ethics Hours Included (must be 6 or more): _____

Training Provider Attestation

I certify that the applicant named above has successfully completed the training hours documented on this form through our AHCCCS-recognized Peer Support Employment Training Program.

Provider Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name & Title: _____

Organization / Program: _____

Phone: _____

Recertification Requirements

Renewal Cycle: The Peer Recovery Associate credential must be renewed every two (2) years.

Renewal Fee: \$150.00 (non-refundable)

Continuing Education: Certificants must complete a minimum of 20 continuing education (CE) hours during each two-year renewal period. A minimum of 6 of those hours must specifically address ethics.

Acceptable CE: Continuing education must be relevant to peer support practice, recovery, behavioral health, or professional development. ABCAC reserves the right to approve or reject CE activities.

Renewal Page: www.abcac.org/renewal

Recertification Checklist

Completed Renewal Application

CE Documentation — documentation of 20 CE hours (certificates, transcripts, or letters from providers)

Ethics CE — documentation of 6 ethics CE hours included within the 20 hours

Renewal Fee — renewal fee of \$150.00 (check or money order payable to ABCAC)

Disciplinary Procedures

ABCAC maintains the authority to investigate complaints, impose sanctions, and revoke or suspend certifications in accordance with its disciplinary procedures. The following summarizes the ABCAC disciplinary process:

1. Complaints against a certificant may be submitted in writing to ABCAC by any person.
2. ABCAC will review the complaint to determine whether it falls within its jurisdiction and meets the threshold for investigation.
3. The certificant against whom a complaint has been filed will be notified in writing and given the opportunity to respond.
4. ABCAC may appoint an investigation committee to gather facts, interview parties, and review documentation.
5. Following investigation, ABCAC may dismiss the complaint, issue a letter of concern, require remediation, impose probation, suspend the certification, or revoke the certification.
6. The certificant has the right to appeal any adverse decision in accordance with ABCAC's appeal procedures.
7. All disciplinary proceedings shall be conducted in a fair, impartial, and timely manner.
8. ABCAC may report substantiated disciplinary actions to IC&RC and other relevant authorities as required.

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www.abcac.org/initial-certification*